

Word family: **term / terms / termed / terming / terminology / terminological**

Base word: term

Forms: terms, termed, terming

Related forms: terminology, terminological

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related noun and adjective forms (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “In **terms of** appearance, it is not the most ornate building in the world...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **in terms of** means **with regard to / when considering a particular aspect**.

繁體中文： **就.....而言；從.....方面來看；在.....這一點上**

中文翻譯：

> “In **terms of** appearance...”

「**就外觀而言 / 從外觀方面來看**.....」

Here:

in terms of appearance = 從外觀這個角度來看

This is a fixed construction built from **term**, and it is essential to the target sentence.

1. **term = word or expression with a particular meaning (詞語 / 術語) — 詞；術語；用語**

Meaning: A word or expression used to refer to something, especially in a particular subject or context.

Practice 1

> “‘Photosynthesis’ is a scientific **term**.”

「photosynthesis 是一個科學**術語**。」

Practice 2

> “What does this legal **term** mean?”

「這個法律**術語**是甚麼意思？」

****term = 在某個領域、主題或語境中具有特定意思的詞或表達方式****

Common:

- * technical term
- * legal term
- * medical term
- * scientific term
- * informal term

This is one of the central meanings of ****term****.

2. ****term = period of time (時期) — 期間 ; 任期 ; 學期****

****Term**** can mean a fixed or defined period of time.

Practice 3

> “The president served a four-year ****term****.”

「總統任職一個四年的****任期****。」

Practice 4

> “The new school ****term**** begins next week.”

「新的****學期****下星期開始。」

****term = 一段有明確開始和結束的時間****

Common:

- * school term
- * academic term
- * term of office
- * prison term
- * fixed term

This is a major distinct sense.

3. **terms** = conditions of an agreement (條款 / 條件) — 條款 ; 條件

In the plural, **terms** often means the conditions under which an agreement, deal, contract, or arrangement operates.

Practice 5

> “We agreed to the **terms** of the contract.”

「我們同意了合約的**條款**。」

Practice 6

> “The two sides could not agree on the **terms**.”

「雙方未能就**條件 / 條款**達成協議。」

terms = 協議、合約或安排中規定的條件和細節

Common:

- * terms and conditions
- * payment terms
- * contract terms
- * agree on terms

This is a major plural sense.

4. **terms** = relationship between people (關係狀態) — 關係 ; 相處狀況

In expressions such as **on good terms**, **on friendly terms**, **on speaking terms**, **terms** refers to the state of a relationship.

Practice 7

> “They are still on good **terms**.”

「他們仍然**關係良好**。」

Practice 8

> “The two colleagues are no longer on speaking **terms**.”

「那兩位同事已經**互不交談 / 關係惡化**。」

****be on ... terms = 處於某種人際關係狀態****

This is a distinct idiomatic plural use.

5. ****in terms of = with regard to a particular aspect (就.....而言) — 就.....而言 ; 從.....方面來看****

This is the exact construction used in your passage.

Practice 9 — Original

> “In ****terms of**** appearance, the building is quite simple.”

「****就外觀而言****，這棟建築相當簡潔。」

Practice 10

> “The two products are similar in ****terms of**** price.”

「****就價格而言****，這兩款產品很相似。」

Practice 11

> “The city has improved greatly in ****terms of**** transport.”

「這座城市****在交通方面****有很大改善。」

****in terms of = 從某個特定角度、方面或標準來看****

This is best treated as a fixed construction rather than a separate lexical sense of bare ****term****.

6. ****term = call/name something in a particular way (動詞) — 稱為 ; 稱作****

As a verb, ****term**** means to describe or name something using a particular word or phrase.

Practice 12

> “The condition is medically ****termed**** insomnia.”

「這種情況在醫學上被****稱為****失眠。」

Practice 13

> “The period was later **termed** a turning point.”

「那段時期後來被**稱為**轉捩點。」

term something X = 用某個名稱或詞語稱呼某事物

This is a major verb sense related to Meaning 1.

7. **term** = mathematical component/expression (數學) — 項 ; 項數

In mathematics, a **term** is one part of an expression or sequence.

Practice 14

> “Combine the like **terms**.”

「把同類**項**合併。」

Practice 15

> “The first **term** in the sequence is 2.”

「這個數列的第一**項**是 2。」

term = 數式、方程式或數列中的一個構成部分

This is an established domain-specific sense.

8. **term** = pregnancy stage / full term (醫學) — 妊娠期 ; 足月

In medicine, **term** can refer to the expected length of pregnancy, especially in **full term**.

Practice 16

> “The baby was born at full **term**.”

「嬰兒在**足月**時出生。」

Practice 17

> “She carried the pregnancy to **term**.”

「她的妊娠維持至**足月**。」

term = 妊娠達到正常預期完成階段的時期

This is a useful medical-domain sense, though lower priority for general learners.

9. **term** = sentence/punishment period (法律) — 刑期

A **prison term** is a period someone must spend in prison.

Practice 18

> “He received a five-year prison **term**.”

「他被判五年**刑期**。」

This belongs under the broader period-of-time sense, so I would not count it separately.

Related form: **terminology**

Terminology means the system or set of specialized terms used in a subject.

Practice 19

> “Medical **terminology** can be difficult for beginners.”

「醫學**術語系統 / 專門用語**對初學者來說可能很難。」

terminology = 某個專業領域所使用的一整套專門詞語

This is a strong family extension from Meaning 1.

Related form: **terminological**

Terminological means relating to terminology or choice/use of terms.

Practice 20

> “The debate partly involves a **terminological** difference.”

「這場爭論部分涉及**術語上的**差異。」

This is valid but more academic and lower priority.

Important distinction: **term vs word**

word

= any individual word in language

term

= a word or expression used with a particular meaning, often in a specific field

> “heart” is a word

> “myocardial infarction” is a medical term

So every term is linguistic material, but not every ordinary word is a specialized term.

Important distinction: **term vs phrase**

phrase

= a group of words functioning together

term

= a word or expression used to name or describe a concept

A term can be one word or multiple words.

Important distinction: **term vs condition**

This is important because both appear in contracts.

term

= one rule, condition, or detail of an agreement

condition

= a requirement that must be satisfied

They overlap heavily in:

> terms and conditions

but **term** often has the broader sense of contractual provision.

Important distinction: **term vs period**

period

= any span of time

term

= a defined, organized, or officially fixed period

> school term

> presidential term

So **term** is often more institutional.

Important distinction: **term vs semester**

term

= any division of an academic year

semester

= specifically one of two main divisions

A school can have:

* two semesters

* three terms

depending on its system.

Important distinction: **term vs label**

label

often emphasizes a name applied to categorize someone or something.

term

is broader and more neutral as linguistic vocabulary.

> a technical term

> a negative label

Grammar note: **on good terms**

This expression is always plural:

> on good terms

> on bad terms

> on friendly terms

Not:

> on a good term ❌

Grammar note: **in terms of**

This fixed phrase is extremely common:

> in terms of cost

> in terms of quality

> in terms of appearance

It means:

> regarding / from the perspective of

Avoid overusing it in very simple writing, but it is perfectly natural in formal and spoken English.

Countability note

****Term**** is normally countable:

> a term

> several terms

But fixed plural expressions are common:

* terms and conditions

* on good terms

* in terms of

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* ****term****

* ****terms****

* ****termed****

* ****termining****

* ****terminology****

* ****terminological****

The strongest semantic branches are:

* word/expression

* defined period of time

* conditions of agreement

* relationship status

* mathematical component

* verb: name/call

The exact target phrase ****in terms of**** should be preserved as a fixed construction, not inflated into a separate base-word meaning.

Master comparison

| Form / sense | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |

| ----- | ----- |

| ****term — word/expression**** | 在某個語境或領域中具有特定意思的詞 / 術語

|

term — period	一段有明確開始和結束的時間；學期、任期等	
terms — agreement	合約、協議或安排中的條款、條件	
terms — relationship	人與人之間的關係狀態，如 on good terms	
in terms of	就某個方面而言；從某個角度來看	
term — verb	用某個名稱或詞語稱呼某人 / 某事	
term — mathematics	數式、方程式或數列中的一項	
term — pregnancy	妊娠達到預期完成階段；足月	
terminology	某專業領域的一整套術語	

For your original sentence

> “In **terms of** appearance, it is not the most ornate building in the world...”

The exact meaning is:

in terms of = 就某個特定方面來看

So:

> **in terms of appearance**

= 就外觀而言 / 從外觀這個角度來看

For your database, I would count **6 genuinely useful core meanings** for **term**:

1. **word/expression with a particular meaning**
2. **defined period of time**
3. **conditions/provisions of an agreement**
4. **relationship status in fixed plural expressions**
5. **verb — call/name something**
6. **mathematical term/component**

I would keep **in terms of** as an essential fixed construction, merge **prison term / school term / term of office** into #2, and keep pregnancy **term** as a lower-priority specialist extension rather than inflate the everyday core.